

Right The laid-back little town of Salento is a great base for exploring coffee country

Below Colombia's unofficial national dish, *bandeja paisa* is part mixed grill, part tortilla, and extremely filling



Three Days in Coffee Country

Good roads connect the cities with the smaller towns and rural attractions beyond. Though earthquakes have destroyed many historic areas and left the rebuilt cities with a modern face, you can still find old colonial buildings and cathedrals in this area.

DAY ONE Spend the day on a **coffee farm** such as Villa Nora (see Where to Stay, *right*), touring the fields and processing sites and enjoying the beautiful rural scenery.

DAY TWO Visit the **Parque Nacional del Café** (National Coffee Park), just west of Armenia, offering a coffee museum, guided walks, cultural shows, a children's theme park, and an aerial cableway. Or visit **Panaca** in Quimbaya, an agricultural family attraction with farm animals, horseback riding, and an impressive stunt-riding show.

DAY THREE From the charming town of **Salento**, with its traditional central plaza, hike into the **Cocora Valley** with its lush vegetation and towering wax palms, or visit the **Acaime Natural Reserve** beyond.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

There are daily flights to Pereira's **Matecaña Airport** from Bogotá and other cities. **Taxis** are inexpensive and you can use them to tour the region if you don't want to rent a car.

WHERE TO STAY

Villa Nora (inexpensive) in Quimbaya has simple rooms and beautiful views on a working coffee farm. +57 6 321 4424

El Eden Country Inn (moderate), just outside Armenia, has spacious, well-furnished rooms with a pool, restaurant, and bar. +57 6 749 5531

El Delirio (expensive), near the National Coffee Park, has eight lovely rooms in a beautifully restored *finca*. +57 6 745 0405

TOURIST INFORMATION

www.turismocafeyquindio.com

